

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Hostile Takeover

Q I have Windows XP with SP2. After I installed the Service Pack, I've been seeing the following files on my computer's C: drive:
funny_pic screensaver (153 KB)
hellmsn hellbot team (8 KB) (the icon is the same as that of any Visual Basic application)
my_photo2005 screensaver (153 KB)
see_this screensaver (153 KB)

I tried to delete these files both manually and with the help of anti-virus software (AVG 7.0, Norton 2005 and McAfee), but they weren't able to clean the virus. They report a memory virus named "NewWin32 - Memory Virus." I know it's a virus, but what do I do?

Smita Verma

A Your computer is infected by W32.MytoB.EF@mm, which is a mass-mailing worm that uses its own SMTP engine to send an e-mail to addresses it gathers from the compromised computer. To completely disable and remove this virus, you need to do the following:

1. Disable System Restore (Windows Me/XP). To do this, open the Control Panel and double-click the System icon. Then click the System Restore tab and check the box next to "Turn off System Restore on all drives". Click OK.

2. Remove all the entries that the worm added to the 'hosts' file. To do this, open Notepad. Go to File > Open, type in "%Windir%\System32\drivers\etc\hosts", and hit [Enter]. In the file that comes up, remove all the entries blocking access to security-related Web sites such as 127.0.0.1 www.symantec.com, 127.0.0.1 www.mcafee.com, etc. For the complete list, refer to www.sarc.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.mytoB.ef@mm.html.

3. Update your virus definitions either by downloading the latest virus definitions file from the anti-virus Web site or by using the update feature in your anti-virus program.

4. Run a full system scan and delete all the files detected.

5. Delete any values added to the registry: launch the Registry Editor. Navigate to the following keys and in each case, delete the value "WINTASK" = "taskfile.exe" in the right pane:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunServices

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\OLE
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\OLE
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control

Exit the registry editor.

If you are unable to launch the Registry Editor, go to <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/tool.to.reset.shell.opencommand.registry.keys.html>, download the file UnHookExec.inf, right-click on it and click "Install", after which you will be able to launch the Registry Editor and continue with the removal process.

Visually Impaired

Q I have an AMD Athlon XP 2200+, 256 MB of RAM, and a GeForce FX 5700LE AGP card with Windows XP installed. My system used to run smoothly until one fine day the monitor went off though the system was still on. I unplugged the AGP card and started the system on the onboard display (Integrated UniChrome graphics). The system booted properly. On re-plugging the AGP card in, the system display had big coloured blocks here and there. Windows loaded and the system went blank.

When I tried to run games such as Colin McRae 2.0, COD, and CZ Counter Strike (on the onboard AGP), after running for some time, the system would lock up. The display would stay and the system would remain on, but there would be no response. What could be the problem?

Arjun Raj

A The only possible problem here is that your display card has gone kaput. That's the reason for the garbled display in DOS and no display in Windows. You'll need to replace your display card.

The UniChrome graphics is not good enough to support the games you've mentioned, so the system locks up after some time. You could try updating the display drivers, but don't expect too much—this graphics chip is not powerful enough for good 3D gaming.

Getting It All Back

Q My 120 GB hard drive recently crashed. My PC has another, 20 GB hard drive. Is there any software that can help me recover the data on the old drive?

Saurabh Sindhav

A There are many software that can help you recover data from crashed hard drives. Some of these are EasyRecovery Professional from www.ontrack.com, Stellar Phoenix FAT & NTFS from www.stellarinfo.com, Recover My Files from www.recovermyfiles.com, and R-Studio Products from www.r-tt.com to name a few.